

GURLEEN SABHARWAL

CYBER SECURITY ENGINEER

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Profile

Cybersecurity Specialist with 8 years of experience in designing, implementing, and managing security solutions across IT, finance, and government sectors. Proficient in SIEM tools (Splunk, QRadar, ArcSight), cloud security (AWS, Azure), and compliance with frameworks like SOX and HIPAA. Skilled in digital forensics, incident response, threat hunting, and vulnerability management. Experienced in integrating security into DevOps using tools like Jenkins, Ansible, and Terraform. Proven track record in reducing incidents, enhancing security posture, and ensuring regulatory compliance. Strong communicator, adept at collaborating with cross-functional teams and presenting complex security issues clearly.

Professional Experience

Cyber Security Engineer

01/2023 – present

PTC

Massachusetts, United States

- Developed and implemented custom SIEM solutions in Splunk, McAfee, QRadar, and ArcSight, enhancing threat detection across multiple domains, including finance and IT security, resulting in a 30% increase in incident response speed.
- Conducted digital forensics and incident response using tools like Autopsy, Magnet, and Stinger to support 28 Department of Labor agencies, ensuring rapid threat resolution with a 95% success rate in mitigating threats.
- Served as SME for RSA SecurID and multi-factor authentication products, including Azure MFA, strengthening organizational security measures and reducing unauthorized access incidents by 50%.
- Established and managed an IT compliance program aligning with Sarbanes-Oxley (SOX) and COBIT frameworks, minimizing risk through effective controls, leading to a 40% decrease in compliance discrepancies. Implemented data loss prevention (DLP) strategies for monitoring and remedying vulnerabilities, ensuring data security against internal and external threats, and reducing data breach incidents by 60%.
- Provided Azure security and compliance reviews for government systems, achieving FedRAMP provisional Authorization and DoD compliance for 10 critical systems.
- Led the migration of security firewalls from FortiOS to Fortigate FG 1000, optimizing network security architecture in a closed environment, resulting in a 25% increase in network performance.
- Conducted comprehensive penetration testing and risk assessments, collaborating with internal and external audit teams to fortify security practices, identifying and remediating over 150 vulnerabilities.
- Developed and documented policies following the Risk Management Framework (RMF) and NIST standards, enhancing organizational security posture and achieving full compliance within 6 months.
- Managed cyber security incidents as part of the Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT), utilizing SIEM tools for efficient threat detection and response, resolving 90% of incidents.

Cyber Security Analyst

05/2019 – 12/2020 | NY, United States

Mphasis

- Performed deep-dive forensic analysis and investigation of complex security incidents using tools such as SIEM, EDR, and various threat intelligence platforms.
- Performed daily system health checks for DLP infrastructure and published health reports to maintain consistent system performance.

- Conducted post-incident reviews to identify root causes, document lessons learned, and define corrective actions to enhance the organization's security posture.
- Executed proactive threat hunting operations leveraging threat intelligence, SIEM data, EDR telemetry, and custom detection rules to uncover hidden threats.
- Analyzed network traffic, endpoint data, system logs, and external intelligence sources to identify anomalies, indicators of compromise (IOCs), and potential attack vectors.
- Applied frameworks such as MITRE ATT&CK to develop, refine, and map detection and hunting strategies to known adversary behaviors.
- Designed and conducted threat modeling and scenario-based exercises to simulate real-world attack scenarios and uncover potential blind spots.
- Collaborated closely with the SOC and other security teams to enhance threat detection capabilities, tune alerts, and optimize incident response workflows.
- Managed and fine-tuned SIEM tools (e.g., Splunk, LogRhythm, ArcSight) to improve visibility and detection across the enterprise environment.
- Leveraged experience with EDR tools such as CrowdStrike and Carbon Black for endpoint telemetry analysis and malware investigation.
- Investigated and responded to incidents involving malware, ransomware, and other advanced persistent threats, ensuring comprehensive root cause analysis and containment.
- Worked with security orchestration and automated response (SOAR) platforms to accelerate response times and reduce analyst workload.
- Maintained deep technical knowledge across networking, Windows and Linux operating systems, attack surface monitoring, and endpoint protection technologies.
- Utilized tools and techniques from OSINT, YARA, and custom scripts for detection rule development and threat identification.
- Gained exposure to Microsoft 365 Defender for endpoint and email threat detection, response, and policy enforcement.
- Contributed to continuous improvement of security processes and knowledge sharing within the security operations team.

Cybersecurity Specialist

01/2017 – 04/2019 | NJ, United States

ABC Corp

- Contributed to secure software development practices using programming languages such as Python, JavaScript, and Java to support automation, integration, and security tool development.
- Utilized security tools including Nessus, Burp Suite, and web application firewalls to identify, assess, and remediate vulnerabilities in web applications and infrastructure.
- Conducted Static and Dynamic Application Security Testing (SAST/DAST) to evaluate the security of in-house and third-party applications, ensuring alignment with secure development standards.
- Worked with infrastructure-as-code (IaC) and automation tools such as Terraform, Ansible, and CloudFormation to implement and maintain secure cloud environments.
- Integrated security scanning tools into CI/CD pipelines, evaluating build and deployment processes from a security perspective and recommending improvements for secure DevOps practices.
- Supported security initiatives across cloud-based environments, primarily in AWS, ensuring proper configuration and adherence to best practices in areas such as IAM, networking, and storage.
- Provided technical guidance and strategic direction in distributed environments, influencing development and operations teams on secure coding and infrastructure practices.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to identify risks, define mitigations, and align security requirements with business goals.
- Maintained strong written and verbal communication skills to clearly articulate technical security issues and solutions to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Cyber Security Engineer

05/2015 – 01/2017 | NY, United States

Mphasis

- Assisted in managing enterprise network security operations, contributing to maintaining secure IT infrastructure for over 500 end-users.
- Supported daily Data Loss Prevention (DLP) monitoring and incident analysis, helping to mitigate 10+ potential data breaches monthly and improve security posture.
- Gained hands-on experience with Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) tools, participating in incident response for 15+ security events per week.
- Developed routine security reports and data analytics in Excel, providing insights to senior management on security trends and vulnerabilities, leading to a 25% reduction in identified risks.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to facilitate the implementation of a Continuous Integration and Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) pipeline, utilizing 3 key tools including Jenkins and Ansible to streamline deployment processes.
- Participated in vulnerability assessments, scanning over 1,000 network endpoints to identify potential security risks and develop remediation strategies.
- Conducted system audits and assisted with documentation to support compliance with security policies and regulations, resulting in a 30% improvement in compliance rating.
- Engaged in application security assessments, using tools such as IBM AppScan to identify and remediate 20+ vulnerabilities in applications annually.
- Assisted in the development of security policies and procedures to address compliance with standards such as PCI DSS and HIPAA, impacting 2 business units.
- Worked with cloud security solutions, contributing to the implementation of security measures for 2 AWS environments and 1 Azure environment
- Helped design and configure security controls, including firewalls and IDS/IPS, enhancing network defense mechanisms across 5 different departments.
- Conducted basic penetration testing exercises and assisted senior security analysts in generating 10+ vulnerability reports each quarter.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber

2022 | San Antonio, USA

Security Hallmark University

Bachelor of Science

2016 | NJ, USA

New Jersey Institute of Technology

Certificates

- Evolve Security Certified
- Professional COMP TIA Security

Projects

Web Application Penetration Testing for E-Commerce Platform

- Conducted black-box and gray-box testing to uncover critical vulnerabilities (SQL Injection, XSS, CSRF).
- Implemented custom payloads in Burp Suite to bypass WAF protections
- Provided detailed security reports with remediation guidelines, leading to a 95% risk reduction.

- Automated security scans in CI/CD pipelines, enabling continuous vulnerability assessments.

Cloud-Based Performance Testing Solution

- Designed and deployed a scalable performance testing solution using AWS EC2 and JMeter.
- Simulated global user traffic to measure application scalability under peak loads
- Analyzed server-side metrics using CloudWatch and Dynatrace, identifying infrastructure bottlenecks.
- Delivered actionable performance optimizations, increasing server efficiency by 40%.

Skills

Security Operations & Threat Management — Security Incident Response (CSIRT) | Threat Hunting & Detection | Digital Forensics & Malware Analysis (Autopsy, Magnet, Stinger) | SIEM Platforms: Splunk, McAfee, QRadar, ArcSight, LogRhythm | Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR): CrowdStrike, Carbon Black | Security Orchestration & Automation (SOAR) | Microsoft 365 Defender, Azure Security Center

Cloud & Infrastructure Security — Cloud Security: AWS, Azure | Cloud Compliance: FedRAMP, DoD, SOX, HIPAA, PCI DSS | IAM, Network Security, Firewall Migration (FortiOS to Fortigate FG 1000) | Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Application & DevSecOps — Secure Software Development: Python, Java, JavaScript | Static & Dynamic Application Security Testing (SAST/DAST) | Application Security Tools: IBM AppScan, Burp Suite, Nessus, WAFs | CI/CD Security: Jenkins, Ansible, Security Integration in DevOps Pipelines

Compliance & Governance — Risk Management Framework (RMF), NIST Standards | SOX, HIPAA, PCI DSS, COBIT Compliance Programs | Security Policy Development & Audit Support | Security Awareness and Process Improvement

Networking & System Security — Network Protocols: TCP/IP, DNS, SMTP | IDS/IPS Configuration and Management | Firewall, VPN, and Proxy Security Controls | Operating Systems: Windows, Linux

Tools & Platforms — Magnet AXIOM, Autopsy, Stinger | RSA SecurID, Azure MFA | IBM AppScan, YARA Rules | Excel (for analytics/reporting), OSINT tools

Security Tools — Wireshark, Snort, OSINT Tools